

ENGLISH SYLLABUS NON-LANGUAGES

SENIOR 4-6

Kigali, 2026



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FOREWORD

The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is honoured to present the second edition of the upper Secondary School English syllabus (S4–S6). It serves as an official guide for competence-based teaching and learning, ensuring consistency in delivering quality education across the country. Developed collaboratively by subject specialists, educators, and curriculum developers, it supports the implementation of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) and reflects Rwanda's commitment to nurturing students' knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes.

Quality education is the foundation of Rwanda's sustainable development and prosperity. Aligned with the national education philosophy, this syllabus promotes critical thinking, creativity, inclusiveness, and holistic student development. It aims to empower young people with competencies necessary to achieve full potential, equipping them with relevant knowledge, skills, the right attitudes and values to integrate effectively into society and pursue opportunities in a competitive world.

Anchored in Rwanda Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2), this syllabus supports the nation's goal of building a knowledge-based economy driven by innovation, resilience, and global competitiveness. It prioritizes student-centred pedagogy, active learning, and the practical application of knowledge to prepare student not only for academic success but also to become responsible, ethical, and productive citizens capable of contributing to Rwanda's continued transformation.

This syllabus reflects our determination to equip students with 21st-century skills, foster innovation, and instill values of integrity, social responsibility, and lifelong learning. Its success depends largely on the dedication and professionalism of teachers and school leaders. We, therefore, call upon all educators to embrace the approaches, methodologies, and assessment strategies outlined herein with commitment and passion, transforming classrooms into dynamic spaces of curiosity, creativity, and inspiration.

On behalf of REB, I extend my heartfelt appreciation to all who contributed to the development of this syllabus. Your expertise and dedication have been instrumental in shaping a curriculum that responds to the needs of our

students and supports Rwanda's national aspirations.

Together, we can ensure that education continues to be a powerful driver of our nation's development and prosperity.

Dr. MBARUSHIMANA Nelson

Director General, REB

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The development of this syllabus has been a collective effort that reflects the dedication, expertise, and commitment of many stakeholders. On behalf of the Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department of the Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB), I wish to express my deepest appreciation to all who contributed to the successful preparation of this Upper Secondary school English syllabus (S4–S6).

Special thanks go to the subject experts, curriculum developers, teachers, and education partners whose insights, feedback, and professional contributions have been invaluable in shaping this syllabus. Your collaboration has ensured that the syllabus is not only aligned with Rwanda’s Competence-Based Curriculum but also responsive to the aspirations of Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2).

We also acknowledge the invaluable support of development partners and education stakeholders who have consistently provided technical assistance in curriculum adaptation. Your partnership has greatly contributed to strengthening the quality of Rwanda’s education system.

Finally, we call upon teachers, school leaders, and all education practitioners to use this syllabus with commitment and professionalism, ensuring that classrooms become vibrant learning environments that nurture knowledge, skills, values, and positive attitudes among students. Through your dedication, this syllabus will fulfil its purpose of empowering students to realize their full potential and contribute meaningfully to Rwanda’s sustainable development.

MURUNGI Joan

Head of Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources Department

Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB)

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1. GENERAL INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background to the syllabus adaptation

The Upper Secondary English syllabus provides students with the knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes necessary to use English effectively for communication, learning, and personal growth. It builds on the foundation laid at the lower secondary level and deepens students' competence through increased engagement with academic and literary texts. The syllabus emphasizes communication, comprehension and composition. It aligns with Rwanda's Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC) and national development goals such as Vision 2050 and the National Strategy for Transformation (NST2), which highlight the importance of language, literacy, and creativity for a knowledge-based economy and responsible citizenship.

2. TEACHING AND LEARNING ENGLISH

2.1 Rationale

English is a global language and a key medium of instruction in Rwanda. It enables students to access knowledge, participate in socio-economic life, and engage with global communities. At upper secondary level, students are expected to refine their ability to use English for academic and real-life communication.

2.1.1 English and society

English proficiency enhances Rwanda's participation in regional and international communities, particularly within the East African Community and the Commonwealth. Through English, students gain access to opportunities in education, business, science, and technology. It equips them with the ability to express ideas clearly, collaborate across cultures, and contribute to national development.

2.1.2 English and Student

At upper secondary level, students are transitioning toward greater academic independence. English supports their learning across subjects and helps them communicate effectively both inside and outside the classroom. Reading and responding to literary texts enhances vocabulary, grammar, and critical thinking, laying the groundwork for lifelong learning and appreciation of the arts.

2.2 Competences

Competences in this syllabus represent a balanced combination of knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values that enable students to apply English effectively and appropriately. Teachers must design tasks that integrate language skills and literary response, allowing students to demonstrate competences throughout the learning process.

2.2.1 Generic competences

Generic competences are cross-cutting abilities developed across all subjects. They equip students with essential lifelong learning skills and underpin all other competences in the curriculum.

- **Critical thinking and problem-solving skills:** Students develop the ability to think broadly and objectively, evaluate their causes and consequences, and suggest peaceful and practical solutions that contribute to harmony and sustainable living in their communities.
- **Creativity and innovation:** The acquisition of such skills will help students to take the initiative and use imagination beyond the knowledge provided, to generate new ideas and construct new concepts.
- **Research:** This will help students acquire the ability to gather, analyse, and interpret information from a variety of sources, including observations, interviews, and case studies, to inform decisions and develop evidence-based conclusions.
- **Communication in the language of instruction:** Teachers, irrespective of their subject, will ensure the proper use of the language of instruction to help students communicate clearly, confidently, and respectfully in both spoken and written forms, enabling them to express ideas, negotiate, and present information effectively for the logical and coherent exchange.

- **Cooperation, interpersonal management and life skills:** These competences enable students to work effectively with others, respect diverse opinions, and show empathy in group activities. It fosters moral values, responsibility, and active participation in community-oriented tasks such as environmental protection, health promotion, and service. Students also build social skills that enhance teamwork, leadership, and adaptability in addressing life's challenges.
- **Lifelong learning:** Students cultivate curiosity, initiative, and adaptability by linking classroom knowledge to real-life experiences. This empowers them with the ability to update knowledge and skills independently, cope with evolving societal needs, and pursue personal growth and continuous development.

2.2.2 English broad competences

By the end of Upper Secondary education, students should be able to:

- **Read, analyse, and evaluate** a range of factual and functional texts such as reports, articles, academic essays, and media materials, identifying main ideas, supporting details, tone, and purpose.
- **Write coherent and well-organised texts** for various academic, professional, and social purposes, applying appropriate vocabulary, grammar, and style for each context.
- **Listen critically and respond effectively** to spoken information from different sources—presentations, discussions, and interviews—demonstrating understanding and interpretation.
- **Speak fluently, accurately, and confidently** in academic and real-life situations, expressing opinions, presenting arguments, and contributing meaningfully to discussions and problem-solving tasks.
- **Use English appropriately and ethically** for research, digital communication, and collaboration, demonstrating clarity, respect, and critical awareness in communication

2.2.3 English and developing competences

Through English, students develop communication, analytical, and reflective skills that help them participate responsibly in society. These competences equip students to contribute positively to their communities.

3. PEDAGOGICAL APPROACH

Teaching and learning English at the upper secondary level should be student-centred, participatory, and inclusive. Lessons should integrate listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Teachers guide students through inquiry, reflection, and active use of language to build competence and confidence.

3.1 Role of the teacher

The teacher is a facilitator who plans, guides, and evaluates learning. Teachers encourage students to read widely, analyse texts critically, and express ideas confidently. They use drama, debates, projects, and textual analysis to make learning interactive and meaningful.

3.2 Role of the Student

Students take an active role in constructing knowledge through exploration and collaboration. They participate in reading circles, creative writing, dramatisation, and discussions that develop English language skills.

3.3 Inclusive and Special Needs Education

All students must have access to quality English education. Teachers should adapt methods and materials to meet diverse needs, using differentiation, assistive tools, and peer support to ensure inclusion and equity.

4. ASSESSMENT APPROACH

Assessment is integral to the teaching and learning process. It evaluates students' competence in language through diagnostic, formative, and summative methods, focusing on application, creativity, and values.

4.1 Levels of assessment across terms and national examinations

To provide a comprehensive picture of student achievement and development, assessment is conducted at multiple levels:

Diagnostic: Conducted before instruction to identify students' prior knowledge and skills; administered at the beginning of a unit or lesson to guide teaching.

Formative / Continuous: Carried out during the learning process to track progress and provide feedback; implemented continuously through quizzes, projects, class activities, and teacher observations.

Summative assessment:

End Term I: Administered after instruction to evaluate students' achievement of Term I content; conducted at the end of the first term as a school-based assessment.

End Term II: District-coordinated assessment designed to measure achievement of Term II content; developed by schools and quality-checked at the district level.

End Term III: National assessment to evaluate mastery of the entire year's content; prepared, set, and moderated by NESA at the end of the third term.

National Examinations (NESA): High-stakes assessments for certification, selection, and accountability; administered nationally at the end of key education cycles (P6, S3, S6) under NESA's authority. This examination integrates objective questions, structured responses, and applied tasks aligned with CBC principles to holistically measure student achievement.

Average scores from school, district, and comprehensive summative assessments will be weighted and included in the final national examination grading, initially contributing 10%, with the percentage gradually increasing as teachers gain experience and confidence in assessment practices.

4.2 Record keeping

Teachers maintain portfolios, rubrics, and checklists documenting students' progress in reading, writing, speaking, listening, and literary analysis. Records support feedback and reporting.

4.3 Item writing in summative assessment

Summative assessment items must be valid, fair, reliable, and aligned with CBC principles. They should test a range of competencies, including knowledge recall, application, analysis, and values integration, while reflecting real-life contexts. Item writers follow a structured process that involves:

- Identify topic areas to be tested from the subject syllabus.
- Outline subject matter content to be considered as the basis for the test.
- Identify learning outcomes to be measured by the test.
- Preparing a test blueprint or table of specifications;
- Using verbs that require higher-order thinking beyond memorization;
- Applying transparent and consistent marking schemes.
- Greater weight is given to higher-order cognitive skills as stated in the syllabus.

4.4 Structure and format of assessment for the English language

At the upper secondary level, the English assessment will consist of one paper with two parts:

- **Part 1: Written Examination** (assesses reading, writing, and vocabulary/language use)
- **Part 2: Oral Assessment** (assesses listening and speaking)

Both parts together assess all four language skills—listening, speaking, reading, and writing—along with vocabulary and language use, ensuring a comprehensive evaluation of students' mastery of English competencies as outlined in the Competence-Based Curriculum.

Part 1: WRITTEN EXAMINATION

Section A: Reading comprehension and literature Tests the ability to read, understand, interpret, and respond to literary and non-literary texts (poems, short stories, excerpts from plays or novels, and informational texts). Tasks include literal, inferential, and evaluative questions on themes, characters, setting, and messages.

Section B: Language use

Assesses students' ability to use English language accurately, appropriately, and effectively in context. This includes spelling, vocabulary meaning, language use, and appropriate word choice within sentences and short texts, through integrated reading and writing tasks rather than isolated grammar items.

Section C: Composition writing

Tests the ability to write clear, well-organized texts for different purposes and audiences. Tasks include paragraphs, essays, letters, reports, narratives, and responses to literary texts (e.g., opinions, summaries, reflections).

Part 2: ORAL ASSESSMENT

Section D: Listening Tests the ability to understand spoken English in various contexts, follow instructions, and interpret information from audio materials (e.g., dialogues, announcements, short talks).

Section E: Speaking Tests the ability to communicate effectively in spoken English, using appropriate pronunciation, vocabulary, grammar, and discourse strategies (e.g., role-plays, descriptions, expressing opinions).

4.5 Reporting to parents

Feedback to parents should describe students' strengths and areas for improvement across language and literature. Reports should highlight progress in communication skills, creativity, and critical thinking.

5. RESOURCES

5.1 Materials needed for implementation

Teaching English effectively requires textbooks, teachers' guides, literary anthologies, dictionaries, digital tools, audio materials, and visual aids. Supplementary readers and poetry and drama collections enrich the syllabus.

5.2 Human Resource

Implementation requires trained English teachers with strong command of English language, school librarians, and community resource persons who contribute to creative learning experiences.

5.3 Skills Required for the Teacher of English

Teachers must demonstrate:

- Mastery of English language

- Pedagogical skills for student-centred instruction
- Assessment literacy for competence-based evaluation
- ICT integration and inclusive teaching practices
- Professional ethics, research, and innovation.

6. SYLLABUS UNITS

6.1 Presentation of the structure of the syllabus

The English syllabus for lower secondary is structured around key competences, learning objectives and integrated units. Each unit develops communication and literary skills through reading, speaking, listening, and writing. Units combine language and literature activities in meaningful contexts.

SENIOR 4

6.2 English Syllabus for Senior Four

6.2.1 Key competences at the end of Senior four

By the end of S4, students should be able to:

Listening:

- Understand a range of spoken texts including talks, instructions, interviews, and discussions on familiar and some specialized topics.
- Identify key information, viewpoints, tone, and implied meaning.
- Take notes and summarize oral information accurately.

Speaking:

- Participate confidently in extended discussions, role plays, and oral presentations.
- Express and defend opinions clearly using appropriate register and vocabulary.
- Use pronunciation, stress, and intonation effectively for clarity and emphasis.

Reading:

- Read and interpret texts of increasing complexity, including factual, argumentative, and expository materials.
- Identify main and supporting ideas, author's purpose, and tone.
- Evaluate information and draw conclusions based on evidence.

Writing:

- Write clear, well-organized texts for academic and practical purposes, including letters, articles, and reports.
- Structure paragraphs logically using linking and cohesive devices.
- Paraphrase and summarize information effectively.

6.2.2 Senior Four Unit development

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about Rwanda	
S4 English		Unit 1: Geography of Rwanda		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about Rwanda’s geography, population, and economy in spoken and written English, while showing respect for communities and responsible use of natural resources.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Describe the main physical features and provinces of Rwanda. Explain basic facts about Rwanda’s climate, natural resources, and economic activities.	Read fluently texts about Rwanda’s geography and economy. Listen and extract key information from spoken descriptions about climate and resources.	Appreciate the beauty and richness of Rwanda’s natural environment and economy. Develop a sense of pride and responsibility toward protecting natural resources.	Language use Physical features and provinces of RwandaReading Reading text about the physical features and provinces of Rwanda	In pairs, students read a passage about Rwanda’s provinces and identify physical features mentioned. In groups, students create a table comparing provinces (area, climate, resources). In pairs, students create sentences using new words (e.g., “The Eastern Province is dry during the dry season.”)

Identify vocabulary related to the natural environment, human activities, and development. Recognise the proper use of simple present tense, comparative and superlative adjectives, connectors of addition and contrast, and the passive voice for describing facts.	Speak fluently about Rwanda's economy, population, and provinces using correct grammar and vocabulary. Write a friendly letter describing the beauty of Rwanda and its economic activities.	Show respect for different communities and regions of Rwanda. Demonstrate curiosity and cooperation while discussing Rwanda's development and population.	Vocabulary <i>The natural environment:</i> mountain, forest, region, province, landscape, dry season, wet season, temperature, rainfall, humid, cool, warm. <i>Human activities and resources:</i> farmer, field, crop, harvest, banana, coffee, fish, market, goods, export, import, transport, income, production, business, economy.	Individually, students listen to a recording or teacher's description of Rwanda's climate and resources and answer comprehension questions. In groups, students discuss how people earn a living in their community. In groups, students role-play a radio interview between a journalist and a farmer/trader about Rwanda's economy. Individually, students draft a friendly letter to a friend abroad describing Rwanda's geography and development, then, peer review for final copy.
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			In pairs, students get engaged in dictation activities to distinguish meanings of homophone words through context. People and development: rural, urban, inhabitant, population, growth, community, migration, fertile, rich, mountainous, populated, productive, agricultural, economic. Listening Listening to a description of Rwanda's climate and natural resources. Speaking (Oral production) Talking about Rwanda's Economy and Population.	
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			Language structure <i>Simple Present Tense:</i> for facts and descriptions. <i>Comparative and Superlative Adjectives</i> for comparisons. <i>Connectors of Addition and Contrast:</i> to link ideas. <i>Passive Voice (Simple Present),</i> for impersonal facts. Writing (Written production) Writing a friendly letter to a friend describing the beauty of Rwanda (Geography and Economy).	
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			Sounds and spelling Homophones (words that sound the same but have different meanings and spellings) rain vs reign; plain vs plan; son vs sun; flower vs flour...	
Link to other subjects: Geography and environment: Topics about climate, seasons, and natural resources, Mathematics: Reading and interpreting data (e.g., population growth, income, or rainfall), Entrepreneurship: Vocabulary on trade, goods, market, income, and production				
Assessment criteria: Can read, listen, speak, and write about Rwanda's geography, economy, and population using correct grammar and vocabulary.				
Materials: maps, diagrams, photographs, pictures...				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about education and personal development	
S4 English		Unit 2: Education and personal development		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about education, career goals, and personal growth in spoken and written English, while demonstrating motivation, responsibility, and respect for learning.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Identify key vocabulary related to education, goals, and career choices.	Read correctly texts about educational goals, ambitions, and careers.	Develop positive attitudes toward education, hard work, and goal setting.	Language use	In pairs, students read texts or success stories about people achieving their career dreams. They highlight the education paths followed and discuss what helped those people succeed.
Explain the meaning of educational paths and how they relate to different professions.	Listen to a talk or pre-sentation and identify key points about career development.	Show appreciation for different abilities, talents, and professions.	Educational paths and career choices Reading Reading about Educational Paths and Career Choices	In pairs, students match words with definitions (e.g., ambition – strong desire to achieve something) and use them to describe their own goals. They also create sentences using words like “career,” “goal,” and “opportunity.”

Describe different career options and the qualifications or skills they require.	Speak confidently about their own educational goals and career plans using appropriate grammar and vocabulary.	Demonstrate confidence, motivation, and determination in pursuing their studies and future careers.	Vocabulary <i>School life and abilities:</i> subject, lesson, teacher, student, ability, skill, talent, hardworking, confident, perform, progress.	Individually, students listen to a talk or short audio on career development, then answer comprehension questions about the speaker's advice, experiences, and challenges.
Recognise correct use of the first and second conditionals to talk about real and hypothetical situations.	Write a coherent personal statement or career plan that reflects their ambitions, talents, and values.	Respect all types of work and understand the importance of each profession in community development.	<i>Educational goals and ambitions:</i> goal, ambition, dream, plan, future, achieve, study, training, motivate, develop, opportunity.	In pairs or groups, students discuss what they want to become in the future and what subjects they need to study to achieve that. They also role-play interviews between a student and a career counselor.
Recognise how vowel sounds influence pronunciation and meaning in words related to education and work.		Value honesty, discipline, and perseverance as keys to achieving educational and career success.		Individually, students plan and write a personal statement or short essay outlining their educational background, skills, ambitions, and future plans. They peer review and improve one another's work.

	Use conditionals correctly to express possibilities and ambitions in both oral and written communication. Pronounce key words accurately, showing awareness of vowel sounds and spelling patterns.		Career and job opportunities: career, job, profession, work, experience, skill, promotion, opportunity, teacher, doctor, engineer, farmer. Listening Listening to a talk on career development. Speaking: (Oral production) Talking about one's educational goals and career plans.	In pairs, students identify and use conditional sentences in real-life contexts, for example: "If I study ICT, I will become a software engineer." Then they imagine hypothetical dreams using the second conditional: "If I were an engineer, I would build better roads in my village."
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			Language structure First Conditional: to talk about real possibilities or plans in the future. Second Conditional: to talk about hypothetical situations, dreams, or career ambitions. Writing: (Written production) Writing a personal statement or career plan.	
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			Sounds and spelling Focus on vowel sounds in key vocabulary / ɜ:/, /ʌ/, /ɪ/, /ɪ/, /ə/	
Link to other subjects: Entrepreneurship: students connect education with skills development, innovation, and job creation.				
Assessment criteria: can describe educational paths and career options, use vocabulary and conditionals accurately to talk about goals and ambitions, write a clear personal statement or career plan, pronounce key vowel sounds correctly, and demonstrate confidence, motivation, and respect for all types of work.				
Materials: Photographs, pictures, job advertisements ...				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about past times	
S4 English		Unit 3: Past times		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about historical events and national heroes in spoken and written English, while valuing heritage, respect, and learning from the past.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Identify great people and key historical events in Rwanda’s history.	Read correctly biographical texts about important figures in Rwanda’s past.	Show pride in Rwanda’s heroes and respect for their struggles and sacrifices.	Language use Life, great people and historical events in the past Reading Reading a biography of great people in Rwanda’s history	In groups, students read short biographies of Rwandan heroes such as King Mutara III Rudahigwa or General Fred Gisa Rwigema and identify key facts (birth, achievements, contributions).
Explain important contributions and achievements of Rwandan heroes.	Listen to oral or recorded narrations about historical events and extract main ideas and details.	Appreciate the importance of unity, peace, and independence.		Individually, students listen to a narration about Rwanda’s liberation struggle and answer comprehension questions about the event, date, and main actors.
Recognise the correct use of past tenses (simple, continuous, perfect) to describe past events.				

Recognise the use of time expressions and sequencing connectors to show the order of events. Identify and pronounce correctly the different /t/, /d/, and /ɪd/ endings of regular verbs in the past	Speak confidently about great people and describe their achievements using appropriate grammar and vocabulary. Write a short, organised essay about a major event in Rwanda's history using correct past tenses and connectors. Use reported speech to retell statements or events that happened in the past.	Demonstrate curiosity to learn from history and relate it to present life. Values cooperation and respect during discussions and group work.	Vocabulary -People & Leadership: leader, hero, heroine, bravery, struggle, independence, freedom, justice, peace, unity, development -Historical Events: war, independence, colonial period, revolution, ceremony, celebration, speech, movement -Time and Change: past, before, long ago, period, generation, tradition, reform, progress	Students discuss in pairs or groups the qualities that made certain people great leaders, then present to the class. Engage in a speaking task where they talk about a great person they admire and what they learned from them. Individually, students write a short essay titled <i>"An important event in Rwanda's history"</i>, ensuring use of correct tenses and connectors. Practice pronunciation drills of regular past tense verb endings (/t/, /d/, /ɪd/) using examples such as <i>worked, played, visited</i>.
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			-Achievements: founded, led, contributed, inspired, developed, united, improved Listening Listening to a short narration about Rwanda's Liberation Struggle. Speaking (Oral production) Talking about great people who changed our country. Language structure <i>Past Simple Tense</i> <i>Past Continuous Tense</i>	
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	Pronounce past verb endings clearly and correctly in speech	Past Perfect Tense Time Expressions: ago, in 1962, during, after that, then, finally, before, and later. Sequencing Connectors: first, next, then, afterwards, and finally. Reported Speech in the Past Writing A short essay about a historical event in the Past. Sounds and spelling Word endings – ed pronunciation /t/, /d/, /ɪd/ (e.g. worked, played, visited).	Project: “The Rwandan Tapestry: A Geographic and Historical Portrait” This one-week project for Senior 4 combines Units 1 (Geography of Rwanda) and 3 (Past Times), requiring students to collaboratively create a detailed, illustrated magazine or digital presentation that explores the intrinsic link between Rwanda’s physical geography—its provinces, climate, and natural resources—and its historical narrative, profiling key national heroes and events, thereby demonstrating effective communication about the nation’s landscape and heritage while fostering respect and national pride.
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Link to other subjects: History and citizenship: *Exploring historical events, generational changes, and heritage.*

Assessment criteria: *Can describe great people and historical events in Rwanda's past using correct past tenses and connectors, write a short essay about an important event, pronounce past verb endings accurately, and demonstrate pride, respect, and appreciation for the country's heroes and history*

Materials: *Printed biographies of Rwandan heroes, charts showing historical timelines, maps of Rwanda, pictures of leaders, flashcards with key vocabulary, audio stories or recorded narrations of historical events, short video clips.*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about giving first aid	
S4 English		Unit 4: First aid		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about first aid and emergency responses in spoken and written English, while showing empathy, calmness, and readiness to help others.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Identify key vocabulary related to first aid and emergency situations. Explain basic steps for giving first aid in different scenarios. Recognise the correct use of imperatives and modal verbs when giving advice or instructions	Read correctly texts or scenarios about first aid procedures and advice. Listen to short recordings or narrations about first aid situations and identify main actions or safety steps. Speak clearly and confidently to give advice and instructions on how to respond to different emergencies.	Show care, responsibility, and empathy toward people in need of help. Demonstrate calmness and cooperation when discussing or acting out emergency situations.	Language use Giving first aid Reading texts about: Giving first aid (Practical advice for giving first aid). Vocabulary Words related to first aid: wound, bleeding, bandage, burn, accident, emergency, ambulance, patient, treatment, injury, medicine	In small groups, students read short passages or illustrated guides about giving first aid and identify main steps and tools used. Discuss in groups different emergency situations and how to respond to each (e.g., burns, bleeding, fainting).

Distinguish between long and short vowel sounds in words related to first aid Recognise the importance of remaining calm and acting quickly during emergencies.	Write a short story or narrative describing a first aid situation, showing correct use of imperatives and modals. Pronounce and spell correctly key words with long and short vowel sounds such as <i>bleed, injury, burn, and help</i>.	Appreciate the importance of safety, first aid knowledge, and helping others. Value teamwork and willingness to take initiative in emergencies	Listening Audio or reading about first aid situations. Speaking (Oral production) A presentation on first aid advice for various situations. Language structure imperative sentences and modals of advice (should/shouldn't, must/mustn't) Imperatives: <i>Wash your hands! Cover the wound! Don't panic!</i> Modals: <i>You should call for help. You must keep calm.</i> Writing: (Written production) A story about a first aid emergency situation.	Listen to an audio or teacher narration describing a first aid case, then answer comprehension questions in groups. Engage in a role-play or dialogue activity where students give advice using imperatives and modals. (e.g., "Don't move the patient," "You should call the ambulance").
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			Sounds and spelling Long and short vowel Sounds: Long /i:/ sound: bleed, treat, clean. Short /ɪ/ sound: injury, bandage. /e/ ben, help, /ɜ:/ sound: burn, turn, first.	In pairs, students write a short story about a real or imagined first aid situation they witnessed or imagined, using correct grammar and sequencing of actions. In pairs, students practise pronunciation of long and short vowel sounds through repetition drills and word sorting exercises.
Link to other subjects: Biology: Human body, Health and Hygiene				
Assessment criteria: can give clear advice and instructions about first aid situations using correct imperatives and modals, read and write about emergency responses, pronounce first aid vocabulary accurately, and demonstrate responsibility, calmness, and willingness to help others.				
Materials: Charts or posters showing first aid steps, flashcards with key vocabulary, first aid kit or pictures of items (bandage, plaster, thermometer), short audio or video clips on first aid				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about healthy relationships	
S4 English		Unit 5: Friendship		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about friendships and social interactions, while demonstrating respect, trust, and responsible behaviour.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Explain key vocabulary related to friendship, social interaction, and safe relationships. Recognise the correct use of reported speech to convey what someone said or advised	Read fluently stories or texts about friendship and social interactions. Listen to conversations about daily activities and friendships and identify main ideas.	Show respect, trust, and empathy toward friends and peers. Value honesty, loyalty, and supportive behaviour in relationship.	Language use Building and maintaining healthy relationships. Reading Reading a story about friendship and social interaction Vocabulary Describing friends: friendly, kind, helpful, honest, loyal, caring, supportive, cheerful, patient, reliable	In pairs, students read a story about friendship and identify qualities of good friends, noting vocabulary such as <i>loyal, supportive, helpful, caring</i>. Individually, students listen to audio conversations about friends and answer comprehension questions.

Recognise the correct use of modals to make polite offers and requests Distinguish and pronounce common English diphthongs in friendship-related vocabulary.	Speak confidently about friends, activities, and safe, responsible relationships using appropriate vocabulary, modals, and reported speech. Write descriptive paragraphs about friendships, daily activities, and interactions with peers. Pronounce diphthongs correctly in various words	Demonstrate responsibility and safe behaviour in social interactions. Appreciate diversity and cooperation in peer relationships.	Activities and social interaction: play, visit, chat, share, help, celebrate, invite, join, participate, spend time Friendship and relationship language: offer, request, advice, respect, trust, conflict, relationship, peer, boyfriend, girlfriend, safe, responsible Listening Listening to conversations about friendship and daily activities. Speaking: (Oral production) Talking about friends, activities, and safe relationships.	In small groups, students engage in discussions about good and bad friends, and safe relationships. Individually, students write descriptive paragraphs about their own friends, social activities, and how they maintain safe and responsible relationships, incorporating modals and reported speech. In pairs, students Practice pronouncing diphthongs (/eɪ/, /aɪ/, /ɔɪ/, /aʊ/, /əʊ/, /ɪə/, /eə/, /ʊə/) in relevant words through repetition, reading aloud, and minimal-pair drills.
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			Language structure Reported speech – reporting what someone said or advised. Modals for offers and requests – making polite offers and requests. Writing: (Written production) Writing describing paragraph about friendship and activities Sounds and spelling Vowel sounds Diphthongs (/eɪ/; /aɪ/; /ɔɪ/; /aʊ/; /əʊ/; /ɪə/; /eə/; /ʊə/) E.g: /eɪ/: may, say, /aɪ/: like, my; /ɔɪ/: boy, join; /aʊ/: now, how; /əʊ/: go, no; /ɪə/: here, near; /eə/: care, share; /ʊə/: sure, pure,	Project: In groups, students design and present a community care campaign promoting first aid awareness and positive peer relationships. They create posters and leaflets explaining basic first aid procedures and produce a short role-play video demonstrating how to provide both medical and emotional support during emergency situations.
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Link to other subjects: Biology and Languages: *friendships, describing people, politeness in Citizenship*

Assessment criteria: *Can describe friends and social activities using appropriate vocabulary, reported speech, and modals, write descriptive paragraphs about friendships and responsible interactions, pronounce diphthongs accurately, and demonstrate respect, trust, and responsible behavior in peer relationships*

Materials: *Texts about friendship, audio recordings of conversations, flashcards with friendship vocabulary, charts illustrating qualities of friends and social activities, audio tools for pronunciation drills*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating leadership and famous people	
S4 English		Unit 6: Leadership and famous people		No of periods: 15
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about leaders and role models while showing respect, ethical awareness, and civic responsibility.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Identify key vocabulary related to leadership, role models, achievements, and personal qualities Recognise the roles and contributions of Rwandan leaders and public figures.	Read fluently short biographies of Rwandan leaders or public figures. Listen to talks or audio recordings about leaders' achievements and leadership styles, identifying main ideas.	Appreciate leadership qualities such as honesty, fairness, bravery, and responsibility. Show respect and admiration for role models and public figures.	Language use Understanding leadership and recognizing role models in Rwanda. Reading Reading a short biography of a Rwandan leader or public figure.	In pairs, students read short biographies of Rwandan leaders or role models, highlighting achievements, qualities, and contributions. Individually, students listen to audio recordings or talks describing a leader's impact and answer comprehension questions.

Recognise the correct use of simple past tense to describe leaders' actions and achievements. Use reported speech to convey what leaders or people have said. Recognise the correct use of first conditional sentences to give opinions or advice on leadership Distinguish short and long vowel sounds in minimal pairs.	Speak confidently to present information about a leader and explain their impact on society using appropriate grammar and vocabulary Write a short biography or opinion piece describing a leader's qualities, achievements, and influence. Pronounce minimal pair vowels accurately in relevant vocabulary.	Value civic responsibility, ethical behaviour, and national development. Demonstrate integrity and responsibility in expressing opinions about leadership.	Vocabulary Leadership and Qualities: leader, leadership, style, authority, democratic, responsible, honest, brave, hardworking, respectful, fair, trustworthy Achievements and Influence: achieve, reform, develop, inspire, motivate, impact, success, change, contribution, role model Character and Opinion Language: character, personality, respected, admired, opinion, compare, influence, qualities, admire, value	In groups, students engage in group discussions to compare the qualities and achievements of different leaders. Report orally what a leader said using reported speech, e.g., "The president said that education is a priority." Role-play interviews or presentations about a Rwandan leader, explaining their influence on society using first conditional statements. Write a short biography or opinion piece about a leader, including actions, achievements, and qualities, using simple past tense and appropriate connectors.
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			Listening Listen to an audio recording or a talk about a leader's achievements or leadership style. Speaking: (Oral production) Presentation on a famous modern Rwandan personality/leader and their impact on Rwandan society. Language structure Simple Past Tense: to describe achievements and actions of leaders. Reported Speech: to report what leaders or people said.	Practice pronunciation of short and long vowel minimal pairs in context through repetition and reading aloud exercises.
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			.First Conditional: to give opinions or advice about leadership situations Writing: (written production) Writing a short biography or opinion piece about a leader. Sounds and spelling Minimal Pairs for vowels Short vs Long Vowels sit / seat (short /ɪ/ vs long /i:/) team / tim (long /i:/ vs short /ɪ/) short/shot (long /ɔ:/ vs short /ɒ/)	
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Link to other subjects: History and citizenship: Leadership, leadership styles, history of Rwanda

Assessment criteria: Can describe a Rwandan leader's qualities, achievements, and impact using simple past tense, reported speech, and first conditional sentences, write a short biography or opinion piece, pronounce vowel minimal pairs correctly, and demonstrate respect and appreciation for leadership and role models

Materials: Short biographies of Rwandan leaders or public figures, audio recordings or talks, flashcards with leadership vocabulary, charts of qualities and achievements, and audio tools for practicing minimal pairs

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about business development	
S4 English		Unit 7: Business		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about entrepreneurship and business development while demonstrating creativity, responsibility, and ethical decision-making.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Explain key vocabulary related to entrepreneurship, business planning, production, marketing, and business development.	Read fluently a case study about a young entrepreneur and identify challenges, strategies, and outcomes.	Demonstrate creativity, initiative, and responsibility in planning and discussing business ideas.	Language use Entrepreneurs and business development Reading A case study about a young entrepreneur starting a business.	In small groups, students read a case study/ Text about a young entrepreneur, identify the main ideas, challenges faced, and strategies used, and answer comprehension questions.
Explain basic concepts of starting and running a business, including goals, opportunities, risks, and profit.	Listen to dialogues, interviews, or recordings about small businesses and summarise key points.	Show appreciation for hard work, innovation, and ethical business practices.		Individually, students listen to an audio interview or dialogue about a small business’s growth and answer comprehension questions.

Recognise the correct use of the third conditional to discuss unreal past situations and their outcomes in business contexts. Use “unless” to give conditional advice or warnings related to business success Distinguish and pronounce consonant minimal pairs correctly.	Speak confidently to describe their own business ideas, marketing strategies, and expected outcomes using appropriate grammar and vocabulary. Write a short business plan or report detailing a business idea, production, marketing strategies, and potential risks. Pronounce consonant minimal pairs accurately in relevant vocabulary.	Value strategic thinking, problem-solving, and risk management in entrepreneurship. Exhibit confidence and perseverance when presenting and discussing business ideas.	Vocabulary Entrepreneurship and business planning: entrepreneur, business plan, idea, goal, opportunity, strategy, cost, profit, investment, risk Production and marketing: produce, product, manufacture, service, marketing, advertisement, sell, customer, supply, demand	In groups, students engage in group discussions or role-plays to present and describe their own business ideas, applying the third conditional to reflect on possible past actions, e.g., “If I had invested more in advertising, I would have gained more customers. In pairs, students write a short business plan or report, detailing production, marketing, and business development strategies, including challenges and solutions.
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			Describing business development: develop, expand, grow, success, progress, challenge, experience, improve, innovation, competition Listening Listen to a dialogue, audio recording or interview about a small business's growth. Speaking: (Oral production) Oral description of one's business idea and how it would be marketed.	In pairs, student practice pronunciation drills for consonant minimal pairs such as <i>plan / bran, team / dean, sell / shell, cost / lost</i> through repetition and reading aloud exercises. Project: In groups, students develop and present a business plan for a socially responsible enterprise in Rwanda. They prepare a personal statement from the founder, describe the leadership qualities needed to run the business, and explain possible challenges and solutions.
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			Language structure Third Conditional: to talk about unreal past situations and their results, often reflecting on business successes or failures. Unless: to give conditional advice or warn about potential outcomes. Writing: (Written production) A short business plan or report on business development.	
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			Sounds and spelling Minimal Pairs for Consonants plan / bran → /p/ vs /b/ team / deam → /t/ vs /d/ sell / shell → /s/ vs /ʃ/ cost / lost → /k/ vs /l/	
Link to other subjects: Entrepreneurship: Directly applies concepts of business planning, production, marketing, and innovation.				
Assessment criteria: Can describe a business idea and its development, use appropriate entrepreneurship vocabulary, apply the third conditional and “unless” in discussing business scenarios, write a short business plan, pronounce consonant minimal pairs accurately, and demonstrate creativity, responsibility, and ethical awareness in business activities				
Materials: Case studies of young entrepreneurs, audio recordings or interviews, flashcards with business vocabulary, charts illustrating production and marketing processes, audio tools for consonant minimal pair practice, and digital devices for research or presentation.				

SENIOR 5

6.3 English Syllabus for Senior five

6.3.1 Key Competences at the End of Senior 5 (S5)

By the end of S5, students should be able to:

Listening:

- Understand longer and more detailed spoken texts such as lectures, debates, and interviews.
- Distinguish fact from opinion and evaluate viewpoints.
- Take structured notes for study and reference.

Speaking:

- Present well-organized ideas and arguments in discussions, seminars, or debates.
- Use appropriate tone, register, and non-verbal communication.
- Clarify, reformulate, and summarize ideas when interacting with others.

Reading:

- Read, interpret, and evaluate complex texts including analytical and persuasive materials.
- Infer implicit meaning, attitudes, and bias.
- Integrate information from several sources to support conclusions.

Writing:

- Produce coherent and well-developed essays, summaries, and reports.
- Present and justify opinions with logical reasoning and evidence.
- Use advanced linking words, varied sentence structures, and accurate grammar.

6.3.2 Senior Five-unit development

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about life in community	
S5 English		Unit 1: Myself and my Community		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about personal and community life through describing hobbies, leisure time, reading and internet habits, facilities, jobs, transport, and social services, while showing a sense of responsibility, respect, and active participation in community life.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of simple present, present continuous, and simple past tenses, as well as comparatives and superlatives, to describe habits, ongoing actions, past activities, and to compare jobs, transport, or facilities in the community.	Describe hobbies, leisure activities, reading habits, internet use, and community facilities orally and in writing. Read and interpret texts about social services, local governance, and differences between urban and rural communities.	Appreciate the value of active participation in community development. Show respect for social norms and community rules.	Language use Life and activities in my community Reading Reading short texts, stories, and descriptions about people's hobbies, leisure activities, local facilities, jobs, transport, and social services in both rural and urban settings.	In small groups, read a short passage about community life and underline words describing facilities, jobs, and services. In pairs, match pictures of community facilities with short descriptions and discuss their importance.

Identify the use of modal verbs (can, must, should, may, have to) and comparative structures (more, fewer, better, worse) when describing and comparing aspects of community life. Recognize vowel digraphs such as <i>ea</i> (/i:/, /e/, /eɪ/, /ɪə/) in words from community contexts.	Listen to and summarize information about community facilities and responsibilities. Write short descriptive and comparative paragraphs or essays about community life.	Demonstrate responsibility and teamwork in solving community problems.	Vocabulary Words and expressions related to hobbies, leisure, community facilities, transport, occupations, social services, and local governance. Listening Conversations, interviews, and reports about how people spend their free time, use community services, and take part in local development activities.	Role-play: act out a conversation between a community member and a local leader discussing how to improve a community service (e.g., road, school, water supply). In small groups, students read texts comparing facilities, jobs, transport in town and country side, focusing on modal verbs and quantity words. Class debate on the statement: "Spending time on the internet is better than playing sports."
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			Speaking: (Oral production) Describing personal interests and daily activities, comparing community life in different areas, explaining local services, and discussing roles and responsibilities in the community. Language structure – Simple present tense: for habits and general truths. – Present continuous tense: for current or ongoing actions. – Simple past tense: for recounting activities.	
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			– Comparatives and superlatives: for comparing jobs, transport, or facilities. Writing: (Written production) Writing short composition or messages describing hobbies, community facilities, jobs, and services, and comparing life in the countryside and town. Sounds and spelling Vowel digraph (two vowels that make one sound) Focus on 'ea' (/i:/ eat, /e/ bread, /eɪ/ great, /ɪə/ ear).	Listen to and summarise audio recordings about local government and social services. Write a concluding reflection on how individuals can support development in their community. In pairs, students read each word and circle its sound: /i:/, /e/, /eɪ/, or /ɪə/: bread, great, health, eat, clear, read; ear...
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Link to other subjects: History and General Studies: countryside, local government, social services

Assessment criteria: Can describe hobbies, leisure activities, internet use, reading habits, and community facilities orally and in writing.

Can compare facilities, jobs, and transport in town and countryside, while showing responsibility, respect, civic-mindedness, and active participation in community life.

Materials: diagram, photographs, pictures, audio recordings, charts or posters

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about climate change	
S5 English		Unit 2: Climate change and wildlife protection		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about climate change and wildlife protection by describing causes, effects, and solutions, while showing environmental awareness and responsibility toward nature.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of future forms, cause and effect structures, comparatives of change, quantifiers, passive voice, and conditional sentences to describe environmental changes, predict effects of climate change, and suggest measures for wildlife protection.	Describe climate change and its effects orally and in writing. Read and interpret texts on causes and effects of climate change and actions to protect wildlife.	Appreciate the relationship between climate and human activities. Demonstrate responsibility for conserving natural resources.	Language use Protecting nature and responding to climate change Reading Articles and reports about climate change, its causes and effects, changes in wildlife populations, and actions taken to protect the environment.	In groups, read a passage on climate change and underline causes and effects. In small groups, students discuss climate change and make a summary, paying attention to the language structures.

Identify vocabulary related to weather, climate change, pollution, wildlife species, and conservation. Recognize that vowel digraphs 'ei' and 'ie' can represent different vowel sounds in English words.	Listen to and summarise reports or interviews on environmental problems. Write short essays or reports describing wildlife protection strategies.	Value teamwork and community efforts in protecting the environment.	Vocabulary: Words related to weather and climate, environmental changes, wildlife species, conservation, pollution, and sustainability. Listening: Listening to interviews, reports, and discussions on climate change impacts, wildlife protection campaigns, or environmental solutions. Speaking: (Oral production) Describing environmental changes and their effects on animals, comparing past and present conditions, expressing causes and consequences, and suggesting ways to protect nature.	Class debate on the motion: "Human activities are the main cause of species decline." In groups, students discuss and predict the effects of climate change, paying attention to the use of modal verbs: may, could, and might. Listen to audio recordings about species decline in Rwanda, and in pairs, summarise key points. <i>Role Play:</i> Interview between a journalist and a wildlife officer about conservation challenges.
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			Language structure -Future Forms (will, going to, future continuous) – to predict and discuss future effects of climate change. -Cause and Effect Structures (because, due to, as a result of, therefore) – to explain environmental changes. -Comparatives of Change (hotter, less rainfall, more frequent storms) – to describe contrasts in climate conditions. -Quantifiers and Expressions of Degree (a lot, a little, too much, too many, enough) – to describe pollution levels or population changes.	Write short reports on wildlife populations and essays on youth roles in fighting climate change. Project: In groups, students research a local environmental issue and prepare a formal report and oral presentation explaining its causes, effects, and possible solutions. They describe the natural or industrial processes involved, predict future impacts, and propose sustainable actions to address the problem.
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			-Passive Voice (future and present forms) – to describe conservation actions and environmental measures. -Conditional Sentences (Type 1 and Type 2) – to make suggestions or predictions about environmental protection. Writing: (Written production) Writing paragraphs or short reports explaining causes and effects of climate change, describing wildlife protection measures, and proposing environmental solutions. Sounds and spelling Vowel Digraphs: Focus on 'ei', 'ie' (/i:/ receive, /aɪ/ height, /e/ heifer).	
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Link to other subjects: *Geography and biology: climate change, wildlife, biodiversity*

Assessment criteria: *Can describe climate change and its effects, explain changes in wildlife populations, write and evaluate texts on wildlife protection, while demonstrating environmental awareness, responsibility, and conservation commitment.*

Materials: *pictures, photographs, graphs, audio recordings, charts or posters*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about traditional family life	
S5 English		Unit 3: Traditional family life		No of periods: 15
Key unit competence: Communicate orally and in writing about traditional and modern family life, describing family roles, customs, weddings, and gender responsibilities with respect and cultural appreciation.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of possessive forms, past simple, present perfect, comparatives and superlatives, relative pronouns, and adverbs of time and sequence to describe family relationships, recount cultural events, and compare traditional and modern customs accurately.	Read accurately texts about traditional family, customs, and wedding. Listen to audio-recorded texts about traditional family customs or wedding.	Appreciate the importance of family unity and cooperation. Show respect for traditional family roles and elders.	Language use Understanding family traditions and celebrations Reading: Reading stories, descriptions, and cultural texts about family structures, birth and death customs, and traditional and modern wedding practices.	Group discussion on extended families; discussing roles of family members and answering comprehension questions. In groups, read and summarise a text about traditional weddings. Class debate on the statement: "Household chores should be shared equally between men and women."

Identify vocabulary related to extended family, birth, wedding customs and gender roles. Distinguish the /f/ and /v/ sounds in spoken and written words.	Speak confidently about their own families and compare them with traditional ones. Write coherent short essays about gender roles and family traditions.	Value gender equality in household responsibilities	Vocabulary: Words related to family relationships, kinship terms, family trees, traditional ceremonies, customs, and celebrations. Listening: Listening to conversations, interviews, or oral stories about family life, customs, and wedding traditions in different communities. Speaking: (Oral production) Describing one's family and family tree, explaining traditional and modern customs, recounting wedding experiences, and comparing cultural practices.	<i>Role Play:</i> enact a family preparing for a traditional ceremony. Listen to audio/video clips of weddings and naming ceremonies. Listen to the teacher pronouncing a word from the list (fan–van, fine–vine, safe–save, fat–vat, leaf–leave), identify whether it has the /f/ or /v/ sound, showing their answer by raising a card (F or V). Individually, write about a family tree and describe some of the relationships.
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			Language structure: -Possessive Forms ('s, possessive adjectives) – to describe family relationships. -Past Simple Tense – to recount past family or cultural events. -Present Perfect Tense – to talk about experiences or traditions that continue to the present. -Comparatives and Superlatives – to compare traditional and modern weddings or customs. -Relative Pronouns (who, whose) – to describe family members and relationships.	
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			-Adverbs of Time and Sequence (before, after, during, then, finally) – to narrate events or customs in order. Writing: (Written production) Writing short paragraphs or compositions describing family traditions, explaining birth or wedding customs, and narrating family events. Sounds and spelling Focus on /f/ and /v/ sounds (e.g: fan - van, fine - vine, safe - save)	
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Link to other subjects: *General Studies:* wedding, birth, death, gender roles, extended family

Assessment criteria: *Can describe family relationships and family ceremonies clearly, and write about gender roles in their families, showing respect for all family members, appreciation of cultural traditions, and positive attitudes toward equality and cooperation within the family.*

Materials: *drawing paper and pencils, family tree, pictures, photographs, audio recordings or videos...*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about scientific progress	
S5 English		Unit 4: Science		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about scientific discoveries and inventions, describing their impact and predicting future developments, while appreciating science’s role in society.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of past perfect and simple past tenses, passive voice, relative clauses, future forms, adverbs of manner and frequency, and connectors of sequence to describe scientific discoveries, explain inventions, and predict future innovations accurately.	Predict and discuss future scientific discoveries and technological advancements orally and in writing.	Appreciate the significant contributions of African scientists and inventors. Value the importance of critical thinking, creativity, and innovation.	Language use Exploring human creativity and scientific progress Reading Short texts, biographies, and articles about famous discoveries, inventions, and scientists from Africa and around the world, as well as ideas about future innovations.	In groups, students read a text about a scientist and answering questions. In groups, students discuss famous scientific discoveries and inventions and their importance to society. In pairs, students match scientific words to their definitions.

Identify science-related vocabulary: discovery, invention, experiment, research, innovation, hypothesis, scientist, laboratory... Distinguish /f/ and /z/ sounds, contrast /s/ and /z/ in plurals/ possessives, and correctly stress multi-syllable scientific words.	Listen to recorded talks and presentations about major scientific discoveries and inventions, and analyse their impact on human life and technological progress. Read texts about discoveries, inventions, and future scientific innovations, identifying key ideas, causes, and effects.	Develop a curiosity about the role of science in daily life.	Vocabulary Words related to science, technology, innovation, discovery, research, experimentation, and future developments. Listening Interviews, documentaries, and discussions about scientists' achievements, inventions, and predictions for future discoveries. Speaking: (Oral production) Recounting famous discoveries, describing important inventions and inventors, talking about African scientists, and predicting future innovations.	In small groups, students act as scientists presenting their invention; classmates ask questions using future perfect tense. Class Debate: "Science has done more good than harm." Use evidence from discoveries and inventions. individually or in pairs, students practise pronunciation through minimal pairs, plural/ possessive word drills, and stress patterns in multi-syllable science terms
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	Write structured essays on discoveries and inventions, using correct organization, vocabulary, and language structure.	Language structure -Past Perfect and Simple Past Tenses – to recount past discoveries and inventions in sequence. -Passive Voice (past and present forms) – to describe how inventions were made or discovered. -Relative Clauses (who, whose, which, that) – to give more information about inventors and inventions. -Future Forms (will, might, may, could) – to speculate or predict future discoveries. -Adverbs of Manner and Frequency – to describe how scientific work is done and how often innovations occur.	Pair students to quiz each other: one says the word, the other identifies the stressed syllable and meaning. Write an essay predicting future inventions using future forms, adverbs of manner and frequency, and connectors of sequence (first, then, after that, finally).
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			-Connectors of Sequence (first, then, after that, finally) – to narrate discovery or invention processes clearly. Writing: (Written production) Writing short biographies, descriptive paragraphs, or future predictions about discoveries and inventions that could change people's lives. Sounds and spelling Focus on the /f/ and /ʒ/ sounds in words like <i>machine, pressure, measure, invention, decision</i>.	Project: In groups, students research an important scientific discovery or invention, with special focus on African scientists, and prepare a "TED Talk"-style presentation on its impact on society and community life. They explain how the discovery was made, discuss its importance in improving people's lives, and predict future developments related to the innovation
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			Contrast between /s/ and /z/ sounds in plural and possessive forms (e.g., <i>scientists</i>, <i>devices</i>, <i>discoveries</i>). Practice stress patterns in multi-syllable scientific words (e.g., invention → in-VEN-tion, discovery → dis-COV-er-y, experiment → ex-PER-i-ment)	
Link to other subjects: <i>History:</i> famous scientists and the historical context of major inventions. Physics/Chemistry/Biology: scientific principles behind specific discoveries and technologies.				
Assessment criteria: Can describe scientific discoveries and inventions and their impact, using appropriate vocabulary, and language structure, plan, write, and evaluate organized texts, while showing curiosity, and critical thinking.				
Materials: pictures, photographs, audio recordings or videos...				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about natural and industrial processes	
S5 English		Unit 5: Natural and industrial processes		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about natural and industrial processes, explaining steps, causes, and results clearly and responsibly, while demonstrating respect for the environment.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of passive voice, sequencing connectors, present simple tense, linking words of cause and effect, prepositions of process and movement, and gerunds and infinitives to describe steps, causes, and purposes in natural and industrial processes clearly.	Read texts describing a natural, biological, environmental, industrial or mining process.	Show curiosity, respect, and ethical awareness of natural phenomena and industrial processes.	Language use Exploring how natural and industrial processes work Reading Explanatory texts and diagrams about natural, environmental, and industrial processes such as mining, recycling, and the greenhouse effect.	In groups, students read texts about processes, with a diagram, focusing on connectors of time and cause-and-effect connectors. In pairs, students match pictures with sentences describing processes.

Identify vocabulary related to natural, biological and industrial processes. Recognise the voiced and voiceless endings in verbs, and mastering spelling patterns with suffixes and word formation.	Orally explain a natural or industrial process, showing its cause-and-effect relationships and presenting the steps in order with a supporting diagram. Listen to recorded texts describing a natural, environmental, industrial or mining process.	Vocabulary Vocabulary related to natural, and industrial processes. Listening Explanations, reports, and discussions about how natural and industrial processes occur and their impact on the environment. Speaking: (Oral production) Describing step-by-step natural, and industrial processes; explaining the greenhouse effect; and discussing ways to make industries more sustainable. Language structure -Passive Voice (present and past forms) – to explain how processes occur without focusing on the doer.	Work in small groups: One says a word, and the others clap or tap to identify the number of syllables in word. Listening to a process description, taking notes, and writing a summary. Class debate: "Are industrial processes more harmful than natural processes?"
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	Plan and write texts describing a process, paying attention to paragraphs structure.		-Sequencing Connectors (first, next, then, after that, finally) – to describe steps in a process clearly. Present Simple Tense (scientific use) – to describe facts and general truths in processes. -Linking Words of Cause and Effect (because, since, so, therefore) – to explain reasons and results in processes. -Prepositions for process and movement (through, into, from, to, by) – to describe flow and transformation in natural and industrial activities. -Gerunds and infinitives – to describe processes and purposes.	Plan and write texts describing a process, paying attention to connectors of time or cause and effect, and to paragraphs structure.
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			Writing: (Written production) Writing short explanatory texts or reports describing natural or industrial processes, and outlining how materials are produced, recycled, or transformed. Sounds and spelling Practice stress patterns in multi-syllabic words related to scientific processes (e.g., <i>pro-DUC-tion</i>, <i>e-VA-po-ra-tion</i>, <i>in-DUS-tri-al</i>, <i>en-VI-ron-ment</i>). Practice voiced and voiceless consonant endings in process verbs: <i>washed</i>, <i>produced</i>, <i>formed</i>, <i>used</i>. Spelling focus on suffixes and word formation: <i>-tion</i>, <i>-sion</i>, <i>-ment</i>, <i>-ing</i>, <i>-ed</i> (e.g., <i>evaporate</i> → <i>evaporation</i>, <i>extract</i> → <i>extraction</i>).	
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Links to other subjects: *Geography:* *natural processes, industrial processes,*

Assessment criteria: *Can describe and explain the steps, causes, and results of various natural and industrial processes; plan, write, and evaluate texts responsibly, while showing curiosity, responsibility, respect, and environmental awareness.*

Materials: *diagrams, pictures, photographs...*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about global community	
S5 English		Unit 6: Globalization and global citizenship		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about Rwanda’s participation in international trade and global cooperation, expressing ideas accurately and responsibly about global citizenship.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of present perfect tense, passive voice, relative clauses, comparative and superlative structures, linking words of contrast and addition, and modal verbs to describe global developments, compare trade activities, and express possibilities in international cooperation.	Read clearly texts about Rwanda’s trade, income, and global connections. Listen to someone talking about Rwanda’s income.	Appreciate cultural diversity and global collaboration. Demonstrate responsibility and teamwork in discussions, role-plays, and group activities.	Language use Connecting with the world through globalization Reading Informative texts about globalization, international trade, multinational companies, and global organizations, including examples of their presence and impact in Rwanda.	In groups, students read texts about Rwanda’s international trade and income sources, and answer the comprehension questions. Individually, students read silently the passage “Rwanda and the Global Market” and then in pairs, answer comprehension questions.

Identify vocabulary related to globalization, international trade, multinational companies, and international organizations. Identify and pronounce key sounds, stress patterns, and correct spelling of globalization and trade-related vocabulary accurately in spoken and written communication.	Describe Rwanda's international trade and sources of income orally and writing. Write structured reports and essays describing Rwanda's international trade and income sources.	Vocabulary Words and expressions related to globalization, trade, international cooperation, business, communication, and global citizenship. Listening Interviews, reports, and discussions about global connections, multinational trade, and international organizations' roles in development. Speaking: (Oral production) Talking about global connections and international trade, describing multinational companies and their operations in Rwanda, and discussing the benefits and challenges of globalization.	In pairs, students act out a short dialogue using correct accent; others listen to and identify rising and falling tones. <i>In pairs:</i> Write a dialogue between Rwanda and another country negotiating a trade deal. <i>Debate:</i> "Globalization benefits developing countries more than developed ones." In a role-play, Student A (a Rwandan trade official) and Student B (a German coffee importer) negotiate a trade agreement for the export of Rwandan coffee, focusing on reaching a fair price.
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			Language structure -Present Perfect Tense – to describe ongoing global developments and achievements. -Passive Voice (present and past forms) – to explain trade and company operations. -Relative Clauses (which, where, whose) – to describe organizations and companies. -Comparative and Superlative Structures – to compare global and local trade or companies. -Linking Words of Contrast and Addition (however, whereas, moreover, in addition) – to connect ideas about globalization.	Listen to an audio recording (or teacher reads aloud) an extract specific information about Rwanda's trade from an audio passage, and write a summary. Write a short report (120–150 words) on Rwanda's international trade and sources of income.
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			-Modal Verbs (can, could, might, should) – to express possibilities, abilities, and suggestions in global cooperation. Writing: (Written production) Writing short descriptive or informative texts about multinational companies, global trade, and Rwanda's role in international cooperation. Sounds and spelling Pronunciation of key vocabulary /g/ and /dʒ/ in words like <i>globalization, joint venture, organization, foreign.</i> /s/ and /z/ in plural forms and verbs: <i>companies, exports, imports.</i>	
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			/ʃ/ and /tʃ/ in words like <i>multinational</i>, <i>exchange</i>, <i>shareholder</i>. Stress patterns in multi-syllabic business and globalization terms: <i>mul-ti-NA-tion-al</i>, <i>in-ter-NA-tion-al</i>, <i>co-OP-er-a-tion</i>, <i>in-ves-TMENT</i>. Spelling focus Correct spelling of commonly confused words in the context of trade and business: <i>import/export</i>, <i>organization/organisation</i>, <i>investment/investment</i>. Compound nouns: <i>multinational company</i>, <i>trade agreement</i>, <i>foreign investor</i>. Words with silent letters or tricky endings: <i>debt</i>, <i>receipt</i>, <i>receipt</i>, <i>growth</i>.	
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Link to other subjects: Entrepreneurship and Economics: international trade, multinational companies

Assessment criteria: Can accurately describe Rwanda's exports, imports, and trade partners, using relevant vocabulary and language structure, speak fluently with correct intonation, while demonstrating curiosity, teamwork, and responsible attitudes.

Materials: *pie charts, pictures, photographs, audio recordings, flashcards/word cards...*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about experiencing life abroad.	
S5 English		Unit 7: Living in a foreign country		No of periods: 14
Key unit competence: Communicate effectively about life in a foreign country, expressing activities, plans, and emotions clearly, while showing respect and adaptability to other cultures.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and Values		
Recognise the use of present continuous, present perfect, future forms, modals of possibility, adjectives and adverbs of emotion, and time expressions to describe experiences, plans, possibilities, and feelings in different cultural contexts.	Describe plans, experiences, and cultural differences orally and in writing. Listen to experiences of people in foreign countries.	Appreciate and respect other cultures. Demonstrate curiosity and responsibility about living in different countries.	Language use Experiencing life abroad Reading Personal narratives, travel blogs, and cultural texts about daily life, customs, and experiences of living in a foreign country. Vocabulary Words and expressions related to daily activities, cultural differences, emotions, travel, and future plans.	In small groups, students read letters or short texts from someone staying in a foreign country, and answer comprehension questions. Individually, students listen to someone saying what they might do while staying in a foreign city or country.

Identify vocabulary related to daily activities, cultural differences, emotions, travel, and future plans. Recognise the pronunciation and spelling of key vocabulary for daily life and culture, enabling them to distinguish challenging sounds, apply correct word stress, and use these words in natural, connected speech.	Read and interpret letters, travel blogs, and stories about living abroad. Write letters or narratives about life in a new environment.		Listening Conversations, interviews, and audio diaries about life abroad, cultural experiences, and personal routines. Speaking: (Oral production) Describing recent and current activities, expressing plans and possibilities, talking about cultural experiences, and sharing feelings or emotions while living abroad. Language structure -Present Continuous Tense – to describe current actions or ongoing experiences. -Present Perfect Tense – to describe recent activities or experiences. -Future Forms (will, going to, may, might) – to talk about future plans or possibilities.	Listen to an audio describing a stay in a foreign country and answer the questions related to it. Role Play: Simulate a conversation between a host family and a visitor adapting to life abroad. <i>Debate:</i> "It is better to study abroad than in one's home country." Group discussion: Compare Rwandan customs with those of another country.
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			-Modals of Possibility and Probability (can, could, might, may) – to describe what may happen in a foreign environment. -Adjectives and Adverbs of Emotion – to express feelings and reactions in different cultural settings. -Time Expressions (recently, currently, tomorrow, next week) – to situate activities in time. Writing: (written production) Writing short narratives, diary entries, or paragraphs describing personal experiences, plans, cultural observations, and emotions in a foreign country. Sounds and spelling Pronunciation of key vocabulary related to activities and daily life: /ɪ/ and /i:/ in words like <i>living, foreign, meet, eat</i>.	In pairs, students write letters or essays describing, recent activities. Project: Rwanda in the Global Village In groups, students simulate an international trade fair by representing a Rwandan export company or a multinational company investing in Rwanda. They prepare marketing materials, conduct business negotiations, and keep a reflective journal on cultural adaptation in global business.
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			/æ/ and /eɪ/ in words like <i>plan</i>, <i>stay</i>, <i>day</i>. /ʌ/ in words like <i>customs</i>, <i>adjust</i>, <i>culture</i>, <i>bus</i>. Consonant sounds to focus on: /θ/ and /ð/ in words like <i>thing</i>, <i>with</i>, <i>other</i>, <i>they</i>. /ʃ/ and /tʃ/ in words like <i>shopping</i>, <i>church</i>, <i>culture</i>, <i>change</i>. /ŋ/ at the end of verbs in -ing forms: <i>learning</i>, <i>living</i>, <i>exploring</i>. Word stress patterns: Stress in verbs vs nouns: <i>re-cord</i> (noun) vs <i>re-cord</i> (verb), <i>permit</i> (noun) vs <i>permit</i> (verb).	
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			Spelling tips for common challenges: Words with silent letters: <i>foreign, psychology, honest.</i> Plural forms and third person -s endings: <i>activities, travels, he visits.</i> Connected speech features: Reductions in casual speech: <i>I am → I'm, going to → gonna.</i>	
Link to other subjects: <i>Geography and Citizenship: foreign countries, customs</i>				
Assessment criteria: <i>Can describe recent and current activities, possibilities, plans, emotions and future activities accurately; compare cultures; orally and in writing, while demonstrating curiosity, respect for diversity, adaptability, and responsible behaviour.</i>				
Materials: <i>pictures, photographs, audio recordings, flashcards/word cards...</i>				

SENIOR 6

6.4 English Syllabus for Senior Six

6.4.1 Key Competences at the End of Senior 6 (S6)

By the end of S6, students should be able to:

Listening:

- Understand a wide range of complex spoken materials including academic lectures, discussions, and multimedia content.
- Analyse purpose, tone, and bias in spoken discourse.
- Take accurate, well-structured notes for synthesis and reporting.

Speaking:

- Communicate fluently and persuasively in formal and informal contexts.
- Deliver coherent presentations and arguments using evidence and examples.
- Adapt language and register to suit audience and purpose.

Reading:

- Critically analyse academic, professional, and media texts for content, structure, and viewpoint.
- Synthesize and evaluate information from multiple sources.
- Interpret tone, style, and intent in complex written materials.

Writing:

- Produce clear, well-argued, and stylistically appropriate texts such as essays, proposals, and reports.
- Demonstrate mastery of coherence, cohesion, and stylistic control.
- Use English effectively for research, documentation, and academic writing.

6.4.2 Senior Six unit development

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about affaires of the nation	
S6 English		Unit 1: Affairs of the nation		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about elections, governance, and civic responsibilities in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating responsibility, patriotism, and respect for democratic principles				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Explain key vocabulary related to elections, governance, and community development.	Read texts about elections, governance, and community participation correctly	Demonstrate patriotism, fairness, and respect for democratic values	Language use Election, electoral processes, and community improvement.	In pairs, students read passage about elections and identify key vocabulary and main ideas, and answer comprehension questions.
Explain the election process and the civic duties of citizens in democratic participation	Listen to speeches about civic engagement and identify main ideas	Show responsibility and willingness to participate in community and national development	Reading A passage about how elections are conducted in Rwanda and responsibilities of good citizens during elections.	Individually, students listen to a local leader’s speech or recorded audio and summarize the key messages promoting civic engagement.

Recognise the correct use of simple present tense, passive voice, modals of suggestion and obligation, and conditional sentences in civic contexts Identify and correctly pronounce words with silent letters	Speak confidently in formal discussions or debates about leadership, citizenship, and national affairs using correct grammar and vocabulary Write formal letters or reports suggesting community improvements and summarizing meetings effectively Pronounce words with silent letters accurately	Value cooperation, tolerance, and informed decision-making in leadership and governance Appreciate honesty, transparency, and active citizenship in civic life	Vocabulary Elections and governance: vote, candidate, polling station, results, political party, fairness, Civic duties and development: citizen, responsibility, participation, Listening A short speech from a local leader encouraging participation in development. Speaking (oral production): Formal debates about Affairs of the Nation in Rwanda.	In groups, students engage in class debates on topics like “Good leaders are made, not born” to build speaking and reasoning skills Individually, students write formal letters suggesting ways to improve the community Individually, write report summarizing local meetings In pairs, students practice pronunciation of words with silent letters through guided reading and repetition.
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			Debate: "Good leaders are made, not born." Language structure Simple present tense: for describing facts and regular actions. Passive voice (present and past): for describing processes formally. Modals of suggestion and obligation (should, must, have to): for civic duties and recommendations. Conditional sentences (type 1 and type 2): for expressing possible and imagined situations. Writing (written production) Write a letter to a local leader suggesting ways to improve your village	
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			Write a report summarizing a community development meeting Sounds and spellings 1. Silent letters • Silent 'g': campaign, sovereign, sign (signature) • Silent 'b': debt, doubt • Silent 'n': government, condemn, column • Silent 'l': parliament, could, would, should (in modal verbs)	
Links to other subjects: Social Studies and History through its focus on Rwanda's governance structures, political systems, historical development since independence, post-genocide recovery and reconciliation				
Assessment criteria: Can communicate effectively about elections, leadership, and community improvement using appropriate vocabulary and language structures, write formal letters or reports, pronounce words with silent letters correctly, and demonstrate responsibility, fairness, and active citizenship				
Material: Texts about elections and governance, audio speeches from local leaders, vocabulary flashcards, charts showing electoral processes				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about teenage problems	
S6 English		Unit 2: Teenage problems		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about teenage challenges, peer pressure, and responsible decision-making in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating self-discipline, empathy, and positive personal values				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Describe common teenage challenges such as bad habits, peer pressure, and irresponsible relationships.	Read and interpret passages about teenage challenges, identifying main ideas and supporting details	Show responsibility, honesty, and self-control in personal choices and social interactions	Language use Teenage challenges related to bad habits and relationships Reading	In groups, students read and analyze texts on teenage challenges, identifying causes and effects
Explain the causes, effects, and possible solutions to negative teenage behaviours.	Listen and respond appropriately to talks or discussions about teenage life and advice	Demonstrate respect, empathy, and positive peer influence in relationships	A passage on the effects of bad habits like drug abuse, laziness, dishonesty, or peer pressure	Match and use vocabulary in context through group activities or role plays

Use vocabulary and expressions related to emotions, behaviour, and responsible living accurately in speech and writing. Apply grammar structures such as modals, conditional sentences, and reported speech in contexts related to giving advice and discussing behaviour.	Express opinions, experiences, and advice using appropriate language structures in both speech and writing Write short compositions or advice letters promoting positive behaviour and responsibility Pronounce correctly key sounds (/f/, /ʒ/, /θ/, /ð/, /dʒ/, /s/, /z/) in words related to teenage issues.	Appreciate the importance of discipline, confidence, and positive behaviour for a better future	Vocabulary Bad habits and behaviour: smoking, drug abuse, drinking, lying, stealing, cheating, Emotions and feelings: stress, fear, shame, anger, jealousy, confusion, regret, pressure. Relationships and sexual health: friendship, relationship, attraction, respect, trust, Positive change and advice: discipline, counselling, advice, choice, decision, Listening A radio talk or interview on teenage challenges and how to deal with them.	In pairs, students listen to recorded interviews or radio talks on teenage problems and summarize advice given Discuss in groups ways to overcome bad habits and support friends positively Individually, students write short advice letters to friends about responsible teenage life In pairs, students write essays about responsible teenage life
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			Speaking (oral production) Discussion on common teenage problems in our school and how to solve them. Language structure Modal verbs (should, shouldn't, must, have to): to give advice or express obligation. Conditional sentences (type 1 and 2): to talk about consequences of behaviour. Reported speech (statements and advice): to report what others said about behaviour or choices. Linking words (because, so, however, therefore): to connect causes and effects.	In pairs, students practice pronunciation and grammar patterns through dialogues or guided drills.
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			Writing (written production) Write an advice letter to a friend who has fallen into bad habits. Write a short composition on "How to be a responsible teenager." Sounds and spelling /j/ sound: Examples: pressure, social, communication, relationship, decision, attention 2. /ʒ/ sound: Examples: decision, confusion, television, vision 3. /θ/ and /ð/ sounds: Examples: think, thought, their, themselves, healthy, with	
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			4. /dʒ/ sound: Examples: teenager, major, education, courage 5. /s/ vs. /z/: Examples: problems, friends, helps, causes, feels	
Links to other subjects: <i>Biology: Understanding effects of drug abuse and unhealthy lifestyles,</i>				
Assessment criteria: <i>Can read and understand texts about teenage challenges and their effects; can listen and interpret advice on responsible living; can express personal opinions, experiences, and advice clearly using correct language; can write short compositions or advice letters promoting positive behaviour; and can demonstrate confidence, respect, and responsible attitudes in communication and daily life</i>				
Material: <i>Short reading texts or stories about teenage issues; Audio recordings or radio talk samples; Vocabulary charts and flashcards; Posters on good and bad habits</i>				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about cultural diversity	
S6 English		Unit 3: Cultural diversity		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about cultures, traditions, and global diversity in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating tolerance, respect, and appreciation for cultural differences.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Explain key concepts related to culture, tradition, and diversity. Identify the similarities and differences among various cultural practices locally and globally.	Read and interpret texts about cultural values, practices, and traditions Listen to and summarize information from interviews or talks about cross-cultural experiences	Show tolerance, respect, and appreciation for cultural diversity Demonstrate pride in Rwandan culture while valuing global interconnectedness. Encourage peaceful coexistence, openness, and empathy in intercultural communication.	Language use Understanding, comparing, and appreciating different cultures and traditions Reading: A short article on the importance of respecting cultural differences.	In groups, students read and discuss articles about cultural differences and similarities In pairs, students identify and match vocabulary to specific cultural practices and customs

Apply the proper use of comparative, superlative, and conditional structures to discuss cultures. Use the proper linking words to compare and contrast ideas in speech and writing.	Speak confidently about one's own culture and show appreciation for others through discussions or role plays Write short descriptive or comparative paragraphs about different cultural practices Use correct pronunciation, stress, and intonation to communicate ideas clearly and respectfully.	Vocabulary: Culture and society: culture, tradition, custom, value, belief, Cultural practices: greeting, marriage, food, dance, clothing, Migration and adaptation: migrate, immigrant, refugee, host Comparative and descriptive language: similar, different, foreign, local, strange, unique Listening An interview with a person who lived abroad and shares cultural experiences Speaking (oral production): Role-play: Welcoming a visitor from another country and explaining local/ Rwandan customs.	Individually, students listen to recordings or interviews about people's cultural experiences and discuss key points In groups, students role-play welcoming a visitor or explaining Rwandan traditions in English Individually, students write descriptive or comparative texts about Rwandan and other cultures In pairs, students practice comparative and superlative forms through speaking tasks and group games
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			Language structure Comparatives and superlatives: to compare cultures, customs, and lifestyles. Past simple tense: to describe migration stories or past cultural experiences. Present perfect tense: to talk about life experiences and cultural exposure. Passive voice: to describe customs and traditions in a formal or impersonal way. Conditional sentences (type 1 and 2): to express possible or imagined cultural situations. Linking words of comparison and contrast: to connect ideas smoothly.	
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			Writing (written production): Write a paragraph describing cultural practices in your region. Sounds and spelling: Word Stress and Intonation	
Links to other subjects: History: Study of Rwandan traditions, and heritage				
Assessment criteria: Can read and understand texts about different cultures and traditions; Can accurately use modals, conditionals, and reported speech in writing and speaking; can listen to and summarize cultural experiences; can express and compare cultural practices using appropriate language and structures; can write clear descriptive or comparative texts about traditions; and can demonstrate tolerance, pride, and respect for cultural diversity in communication and behaviour				
Material: Reading texts or articles on culture and traditions; Audio recordings or interviews about cultural exchange; Vocabulary flashcards and comparative language charts; Pictures or videos showing cultural festivals and practices; Maps showing regions and cultural diversity				

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about personal ambitions	
S6 English		Unit 4: Myself and my ambitions		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about personal strengths, interests, and career goals in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating confidence, responsibility, and motivation to achieve ambitions				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Use vocabulary related to personal interests, career ambitions, and work life Apply the correct use of tenses, modals, conditionals, and reported speech in discussing goals and ambitions.	Read and interpret texts about career ambitions, job opportunities, and personal growth Listen to conversations or speeches about goals and summarize key ideas	Show motivation, responsibility, and commitment to personal growth and self-improvement Develop confidence, honesty, and perseverance toward career goals	Language use Self-awareness, personal interests, and career ambitions. Reading A short text narrating how a young girl has discovered her talent A story about a student who followed his dream career	Read and discuss texts about personal interests and career choices (in pairs or groups) Identify and match vocabulary related to hobbies, jobs, and ambition (individually or in pairs)

Identify the correct structure and purpose of formal documents such as a CV and a motivational letter. Use past and present perfect tenses to describe and compare cultural experiences.	Speak confidently in role plays such as interviews and discussions about ambitions Write a clear and well-structured CV and motivational letter Apply correct word stress, pronunciation, and spelling in spoken and written communication.	Value hard work, discipline, and continuous learning as paths to success	Vocabulary Hobbies and leisure: hobby, interest, leisure, relaxation, Career and ambition: ambition, goal, plan, future, dream, success, achievement, Work and employment: employee, employer, company, organization, job Qualities and personality: hardworking, honest, creative, confident, patient, Internet and modern life: website, online, email, post, download, upload, Listening: - A conversation between two friends discussing their dreams and future plans. - A motivational speech about setting and achieving goals.	Listen to audio recordings or motivational talks and answer comprehension questions (individually) Role-play job interviews or conversations about future goals (in pairs) Write a CV and a motivational letter responding to a job advertisement (individually) Practice pronunciation, word stress, and spelling of commonly confused words (in pairs or groups).
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			Speaking (oral production): Role-play: An interview between a job applicant and an employer. Language structure Simple present tense: to describe hobbies, routines, and personal qualities. Future tense (will / going to): to express ambitions and plans. Modal verbs (can, could, should, must, have to): to express ability, advice, or obligation. Adjectives and their order: to describe people and qualities. Conditional sentences (type 1 and type 2): to talk about goals and possibilities. Reported speech (statements and questions): for interviews and indirect speech. Writing: (written production)	
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			Write a personal CV (Curriculum Vitae) Write a motivational letter in response to a job advertisement. Sounds and spelling sounds: Word stress practice: a-MBI-tious, mo-TI-va-tion, a-CHIEVE-ment. Spelling commonly confused words: (their/there, goal/gold, advise/advice).	
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Links to other subjects: *Entrepreneurship: Business ideas, job applications, and professional skills*

Assessment criteria: *Can read and understand texts about personal ambitions and career paths; can correctly use comparative, superlative, and past tenses to describe and compare cultures; can listen to and summarize conversations or speeches about goals; can speak confidently about personal interests and career plans using correct grammar; can write a clear CV and motivational letter; and can demonstrate confidence, honesty, and motivation toward achieving personal and professional goals*

Material: *Sample CVs, motivational letters, and job advertisements; Audio recordings or videos of motivational talks and interviews; Flashcards for career-related vocabulary and personality traits; Dictionaries and pronunciation guides for stress and spelling practice*

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about space	
S6 English		Unit 5: Space travel		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about space exploration, planets, and future technological possibilities in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating curiosity, creativity, and appreciation for scientific achievement.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Use vocabulary related to space, planets, and exploration	Read and comprehend texts about the history and future of space travel	Show curiosity and interest in science and discovery	Language use	Read short texts about the moon landing and discuss main ideas and key vocabulary (in pairs or groups)
Explain key historical events in space travel and the contributions of astronauts	Listen to information about how astronauts live in space and summarize key points	Appreciate human achievements and innovation in space exploration	The history and future of space travel Reading: A passage about the first man on the moon (Neil Armstrong and Apollo 11 mission).	Listen to an audio clip about astronauts' daily lives and identify key details (individually)

Recognize the correct use of grammatical structures such as past simple, future tense, comparatives, and conditionals in context	Speak clearly about favourite planets or predictions for future space missions Write short descriptive or predictive compositions related to space exploration Pronounce scientific words correctly, focusing on stress and -ed endings.	Develop creativity, imagination, and optimism about technological progress	Vocabulary Space objects: planet, star, moon, sun, galaxy, comet, asteroid, orbit, universe Space travel & equipment: rocket, astronaut, spaceship, satellite, telescope, launch, mission, gravity, station Exploration verbs: explore, discover, travel, orbit, land, return, launch, research Listening A short audio about "How astronauts live in space" Speaking (oral production): Talking about your favourite planet and why	Practice using past and future tenses, comparatives, and conditionals in discussions about space (in pairs or groups) Conduct short oral presentations about favourite planets or future predictions (individually) Write compositions describing space missions or forecasting space travel in the future (individually) Build new words using scientific prefixes and suffixes (individually or in pairs)
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			Language structure: Past simple tense: To describe historical events in space exploration Future tense (will / going to): To make predictions about space travel Comparatives and superlatives: To compare planets or space distances First conditional: To express possible future conditions Writing (written production) Write predictions about What space travel will be like in 20 years from now	
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			Sounds and spelling Pronunciation of ending sounds in –ed (e.g., launched, discovered, explored). Word stress in scientific terms ('astronaut, 'telescope, ex'periment, dis'covery). Building words with prefixes and suffixes (astro–, tele–, –logy, –tion, –ment).	Practice pronunciation, stress, and –ed endings in space-related vocabulary (in pairs or groups)
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Links to other subjects: **Physics:** Concepts of gravity, motion, and orbits; **Geography:** Understanding planets, the solar system, and Earth's position in space; **Mathematics:** Measuring distances, sizes, and comparing data about planets

Assessment criteria: Can read and understand texts about space exploration and future predictions; can use reported speech and appropriate word stress in communication about ambitions; can listen to and summarize information about astronauts' lives in space; can speak clearly about planets and space missions using correct grammar; can write descriptive or predictive compositions about space travel; and can demonstrate curiosity, imagination, and appreciation for scientific discovery and innovation.

Material: Reading passages about the moon landing and space missions; Audio clips or short videos about astronauts and space travel; Flashcards of planets, rockets, and space vocabulary; Charts showing the solar system and key space missions; Dictionaries and pronunciation guides for scientific terms; Models or pictures of rockets, satellites, and astronauts.

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about money	
S6 English		Unit 6: Money and banking		No of periods: 14
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about personal and national financial management in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating responsibility, honesty, and sound financial decision-making				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Explain key terms related to income, saving, and financial management	Read fluently the texts about income, saving, and financial planning	Demonstrate responsibility, honesty, and self-discipline in handling money	Language use	Read and discuss texts about sources of income, budgeting, and saving habits (in pairs or groups)
Identify types of income, banking processes, and the importance of budgeting and saving	Listen to and interpret dialogues or programs about managing money responsibly	Appreciate the importance of saving, budgeting, and avoiding debt	Personal and national financial management Reading A short text explaining types of income (salary, wages, profit, interest, rent).	Identify and use vocabulary related to banking and financial management (individually or in pairs)

Understand the correct use of language structures such as modals, conditionals, quantifiers, and passive voice in financial contexts	Speak confidently in role plays such as loan requests or financial advice discussions Write simple budgets, formal request letters, and short compositions about financial goals Use correct pronunciation, stress, and intonation when talking about financial terms	Show awareness of personal and national financial responsibilities such as paying taxes Promote a culture of integrity and accountability in financial decisions	Vocabulary Types of income: salary, wage, profit, allowance, bonus, commission, rent, interest. Banking terms: bank, account, deposit, withdrawal, balance, loan, credit, Budgeting and saving: budget, expense, saving, Taxes and government finance: tax, income tax, revenue, public service, government debt, deficit, expenditure,	Listen to conversations or radio programs about money management and summarize key ideas (individually) Role-play interactions between clients and bank officers for practical language use (in pairs) Write a short family or personal budget and a formal loan request letter (individually) Practice pronunciation, stress, and word differences (e.g., save/safe, spend/spent) (in pairs or groups) Conduct group discussions on responsible financial behavior and avoiding debt
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			Financial behaviour and advice: borrow, lend, owe, avoid, afford, manage, spend wisely, save regularly. Listening A conversation between a bank officer and a client opening an account. Speaking (oral production) Role play: Requesting a loan from a bank officer. Language structure Modals for possibility and advice: to express financial options and guidance.	
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			First conditional: to talk about financial cause and effect. Second conditional: to express hypothetical financial situations. Quantifiers and countable/ uncountable nouns: to talk about money and amounts. Passive voice (simple present and simple past): to describe processes like taxation and services. Polite requests (using could/ would): for real-life banking interactions.	
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			Writing (written production) A simple formal request letter asking for a bank loan or account opening. Sounds and spelling Correct pronunciation of key financial terms (loan, mortgage, interest, deposit) Differentiating almost similar sounding words (save vs. safe, spend vs. spent) Stress in multi-syllable words (investment, financial, deposit)	
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Links to other subjects: Entrepreneurship: Budgeting, investment, and financial planning; **Mathematics:** Calculating income, expenses, interest, and profit; **Economics:** Understanding income, expenditure, and taxation

Assessment criteria: Can read and understand texts about financial management and saving; can appropriately use modals, conditionals, quantifiers, and polite forms in spoken and written financial contexts; can listen to and interpret discussions about money matters; can speak confidently about budgeting, saving, and financial decisions using correct grammar; can write clear budgets and formal banking letters; and can demonstrate responsibility, honesty, and awareness of sound financial habits and civic duties

Material: Texts or leaflets on financial literacy and banking; Audio recordings of financial talks or interviews; Vocabulary flashcards for banking and budgeting terms; Dictionaries and pronunciation guides for financial terminology

TOPIC AREA: ORAL AND WRITTEN COMMUNICATION			Sub-topic area: Communicating about development in Rwanda	
S6 English		Unit 7: Development trends in Rwanda		No of periods: 15
Key unit competency: Communicate effectively about Rwanda’s progress and sustainable development in both spoken and written English using appropriate language structures, while demonstrating patriotism, critical thinking, and commitment to community and national development.				
Learning objectives			Content	Learning activities
Knowledge and understanding	Skills	Attitudes and values		
Explain vocabulary related to Rwanda’s development, economy, and Vision 2050 Recognize key national development sectors such as education, health, infrastructure, and technology	Read and interpret texts on Rwanda’s development projects and progress Listen to reports or interviews about national and community development and summarize key ideas	Demonstrate patriotism, responsibility, and pride in national achievements Value sustainable development, innovation, and collective efforts for progress	Language use Rwanda’s progress and vision for sustainable development Reading: Short texts about Rwanda’s Vision 2050 in key development sectors such as education, health, and infrastructure.	Read texts on Rwanda’s Vision 2050 and recent development projects, highlighting key vocabulary (individually or in pairs) Listen to interviews and reports on community projects, noting progress and challenges (individually)

Use comparatives, superlatives, passive voice, and present perfect tense accurately to describe and discuss Rwanda's progress and sustainable development. Identify the role of sustainable development and youth contribution in national progress	Speak confidently in debates or discussions about development priorities using correct grammar and vocabulary Write opinion paragraphs, essays, and speeches expressing ideas about Rwanda's progress and sustainable development Pronounce challenging sounds (/θ/, /ð/) and apply correct word stress in multisyllabic terms	Show interest and commitment in contributing positively to community and national development Encourage cooperation, critical thinking, and respect for differing opinions in debates	Vocabulary development, economy, infrastructure, investment, innovation, technology, industry, agriculture, project, poverty reduction, employment, growth, sustainable, modern, urban, rural, progress, strategy, vision, policy Listening Short report on national development programs Interview about community projects and progress	Discuss in groups or pairs the most important sectors for Rwanda's development and justify opinions (in pairs or groups) Participate in debates on topics like "Education is the key to development" or "Technology drives Rwanda's growth." (in groups) Write short essays, opinion paragraphs, and speeches on Rwanda's progress and youth contribution (individually) Practice pronunciation of /θ/ and /ð/ and word stress in multisyllabic development-related vocabulary (in pairs or groups)
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			Speaking: (Oral production) Debate on various topics such as “Education is the key to development or Technology drives Rwanda’s growth” Language structure Comparatives and superlatives to show how Rwanda’s current situation or achievements differ from the past or from other countries. Passive voice to highlight actions and achievements rather than who did them — for talking about national progress or government-led initiatives.	Project: A National Development Proposal In groups, students research a key sector of Rwanda’s development and prepare a formal funding proposal to support its growth. They develop a budget, justify the importance of investment, and deliver a speech presenting their proposal and expected impact on national development.
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			Present perfect tense – to show progress. Writing (written production) A short essay about Rwanda's main development achievements. An opinion paragraph on how youth can support national development. A brief speech titled "My Role in Rwanda's Development." Sounds and spelling Difficult sounds: /θ/ and /ð/ (growth, other). Word stress: de-VE-lop-ment, in-FRA-struc-ture, sus-TAIN-able, ED-u-ca-tion.	
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Links to other subjects: Economics: Concepts of growth, investment, industry, and poverty reduction; **Geography:** Urban and rural development, infrastructure, and resource management; **Entrepreneurship:** Skills in creating opportunities and contributing to economic growth.

Assessment criteria: Can read and understand texts about Rwanda's development and Vision 2050; can listen to and summarize information about national projects; can speak confidently in debates and discussions about development priorities using appropriate grammar and vocabulary; can write clear essays, opinion paragraphs, and speeches about national progress; and can demonstrate patriotism, responsibility, and a commitment to sustainable development.

Materials: Short articles and reports on Rwanda's Vision 2050 and development projects; Audio recordings or interviews about national and community development; Charts and visuals showing infrastructure, education, and health improvements; Vocabulary flashcards and word stress guides for multisyllabic terms; Dictionaries and pronunciation guides for /θ/ and /ð/ sounds